

Wireless mice with wireless power

Welcome to the completely wireless future of this faithful peripheral

While wireless mice with wireless charging features aren't exactly new, thanks to Powerplay from Logitech last year, this year at CES quite a few peripheral manufacturers showed up with their own versions of the idea which does indicate a trend. Corsair launched the production version of the Dark Core mouse that comes with Qi charging. Using Qi charging means the mouse cannot be moved while charging. However, the same charger



Razer Mamba Hyperflux

can also charge other Qi compatible devices. To encourage the use of this particular feature, Corsair has also bundled a charging dongle in the Dark Core package. While the mouse itself will cost \$90, it is not yet clear how much the companion charging pad will be priced at. Thankfully, due to the Qi



Mad Catz R.A.T Air

implementation, there will be alternatives to any proprietary mousepad that Corsair attempts to insist upon.

Razer's Mamba Hyperflux is in its own league. It has ditched batteries altogether to achieve a light 96g of weight, compared to the Corsair Dark Core's hefty 128g. Although that does mean that to work, the mouse will have to be on top of Razer's proprietary Firefly Hyperflux mousepad with inductive charging – with a mere 10 seconds of power buffer post lift-off. While Razer has assured users

that lift-off during gaming should not be a problem, the actual performance remains to be seen when this becomes available. The Razer Mamba Hyperflux, along with the Firefly Hyperflux mousepad, will cost \$250 when it is launched.

Mad Catz, in their revival at CES 2018, brought in the wireless R.A.T. Air that is more or less the same in terms of features as the Hyperflux. It also comes with a proprietary mousepad that is dual-sided and RGB lit, and can achieve a longer duration of contactless performance at about 20-30 seconds. A particular difference that loyalists would perceive is the loss of customisability on the R.A.T. range. Only the palm grip on the R.A.T. Air is customisable for length, unlike the high level of customisation that R.A.T. fans are used to.



Corsair Dark Core

So will you be buying a wireless-charging/powered mouse this year? If yes, which one are you leaning towards? Drop us a mail at editor@digit.in and let us know.

Sennheiser HD 820

Sennheiser's HD 800 and 800 S have been highly regarded as one of the best open-back flagships from Sennheiser. So when they brought out a closed back version of the same as the HD 820, you bet the tech world noticed. This is the audio company's first premium closed-back Sennheiser has chosen to put a glass cover on the exterior of the 820, thus retaining the signature look of the 800 without compromising on what they were trying to achieve with the closed back design. Additionally, the material is Gorilla glass so expect it to be comparatively sturdy. As if you would drop this pair? With a US price of \$2,399, expect it to cost close to ₹2 lakhs on



Indian soil. But that wouldn't stop the hardcore enthusiasts, would it?

The Gorilla Glass over the drivers is curved, instead of being flat, to reflect stray sound waves into the acoustic absorption chambers, reducing the resonances that give so many closed back headphones an in-your-head sound. A few other smaller changes to the 800's design in the 820 would be new ear pads made of synthetic leather and microfiber, targeted at insulation, along with the 4.4mm Pentaconn audio plug that is gaining popularity as the preferred audio jack for enthusiast headphones, thanks to Sony's pioneering efforts.